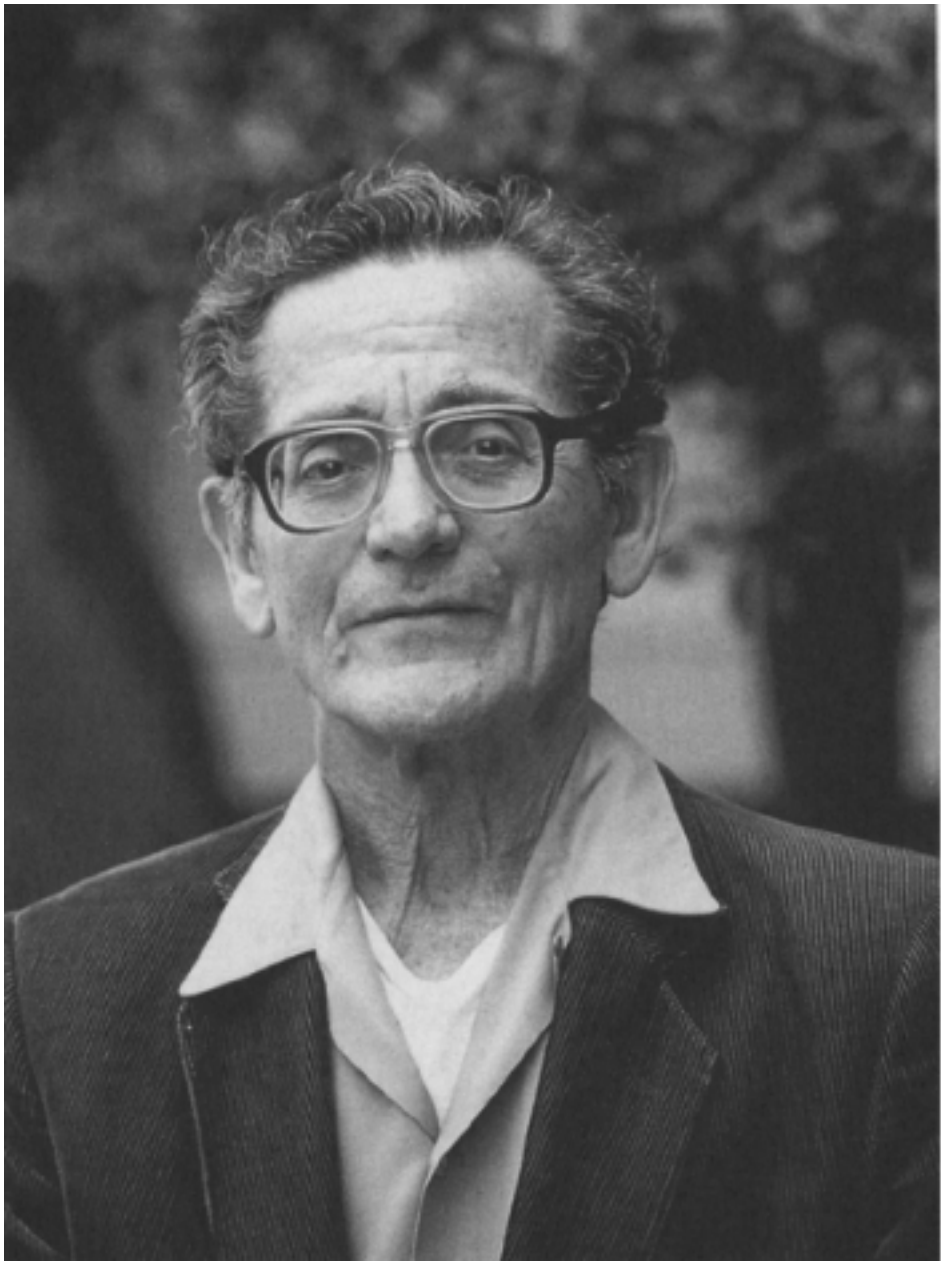


In particular, our focus will be on some groundbreaking experimental results obtained by the late American neuroscientist Benjamin Libet.



Libet's work was on the neuroscience of consciousness. Since Libet thought, not unreasonably, that free choices had to be conscious, he thought that we could try to design experiments which would show whether or not people had free will.

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenge to free will from determinism. Our topic today is a much more recent challenge: the challenge to free will posed by contemporary **neuroscience**.



replies to
Libet

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the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
good?

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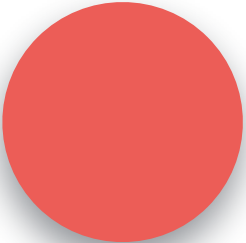
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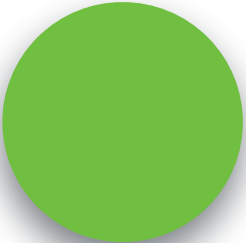
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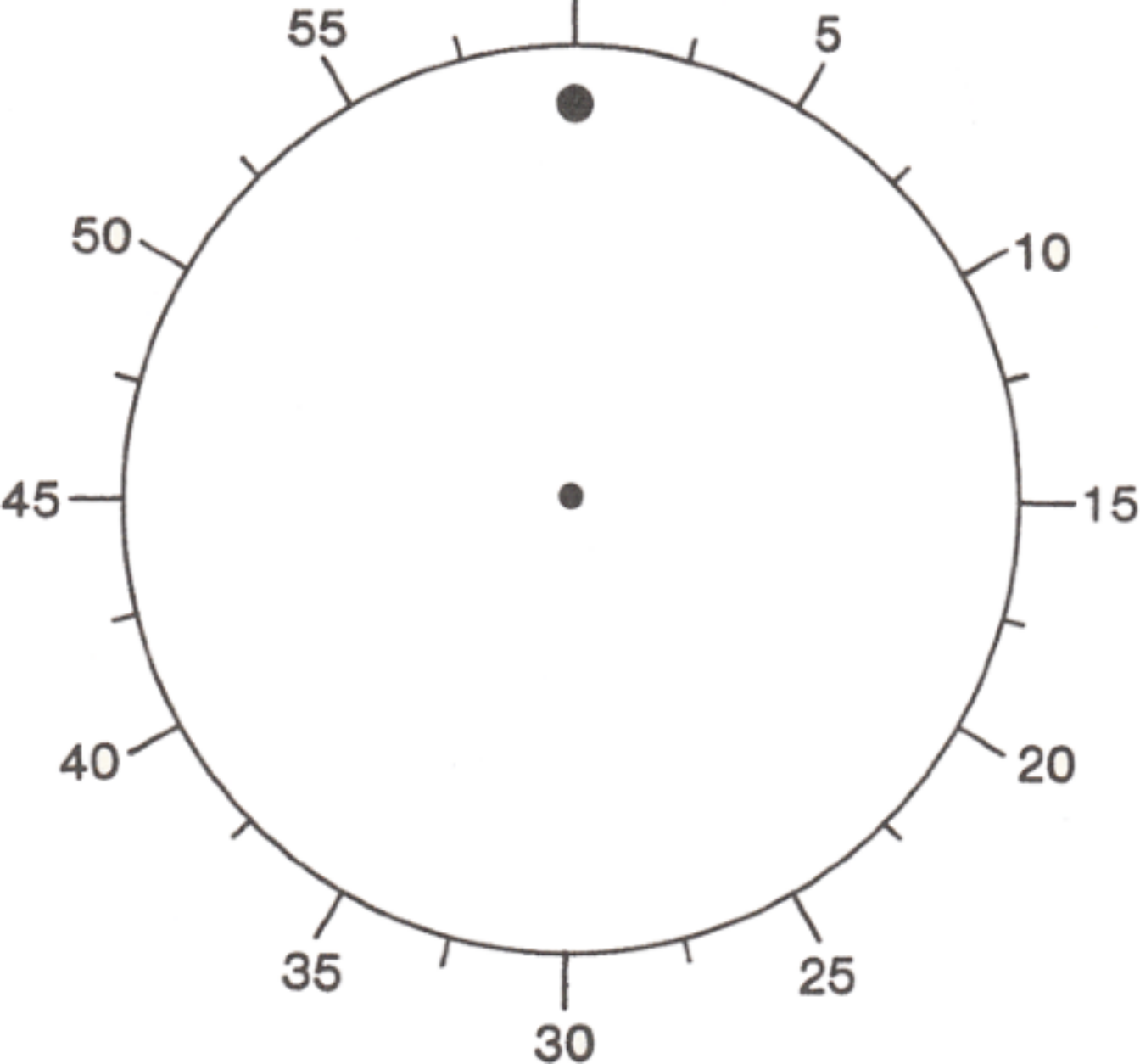


In the central experiment described in the reading

for today, subjects were told to look at a clock with

and dot which moved rapidly in circles around the

clock.



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the Libet
experiments